

John Scali was an American broadcaster, wellconnected to the US State Department. On Friday, 26 October he was approached by a Soviet intelligence officer, Aleksandr Feklisov. Over lunch, they discussed a diplomatic solution to the crisis involving withdrawal of the missiles in return for an American commitment not to invade. Scali passed this to the State Department, where the Americans believed they had opened a backchannel to the Kremlin (which they had not). Feklisov denies the idea came from him. What exactly happened remains a puzzle. *(Public Domain: US Department of State)*